

### **Basic bidding   Notrump raises   Major suit raises**

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

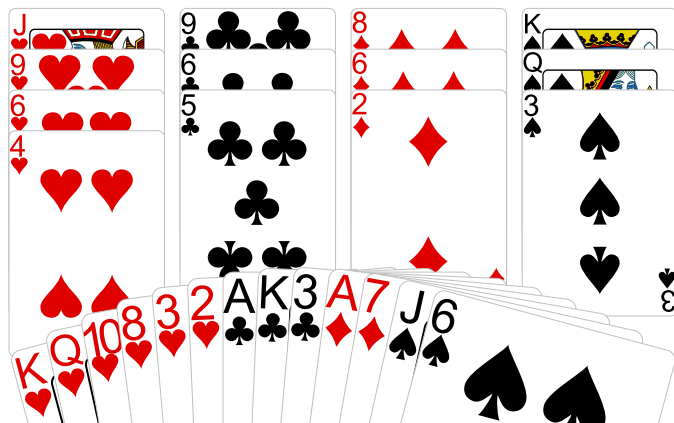
Keep in mind:

- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit

- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit

- it takes 33 points to make small slam

**Deal 1** Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



**Count Fast and Slow Losers**

| ♠ | ♥ | ♦ | ♣ | Total |
|---|---|---|---|-------|
|   |   |   |   |       |

**Decide How to Reduce Losers**

| Ruffs | Finesse | Pitch | Length |
|-------|---------|-------|--------|
|       |         |       |        |

**Deal 2** Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least \_\_\_\_ winners



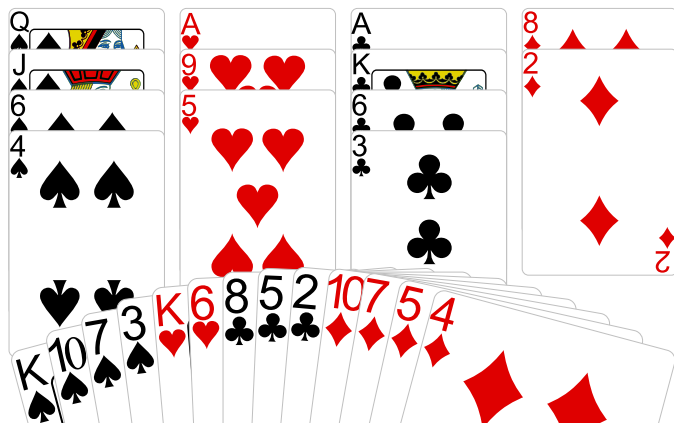
**Count Sure Winners**

| ♠ | ♥ | ♦ | ♣ | Total |
|---|---|---|---|-------|
|   |   |   |   |       |

**Decide How to Develop Winners**

| Promotion | Length | Finesse | End Play |
|-----------|--------|---------|----------|
|           |        |         |          |

**Deal 3** Ctr: 2♠ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



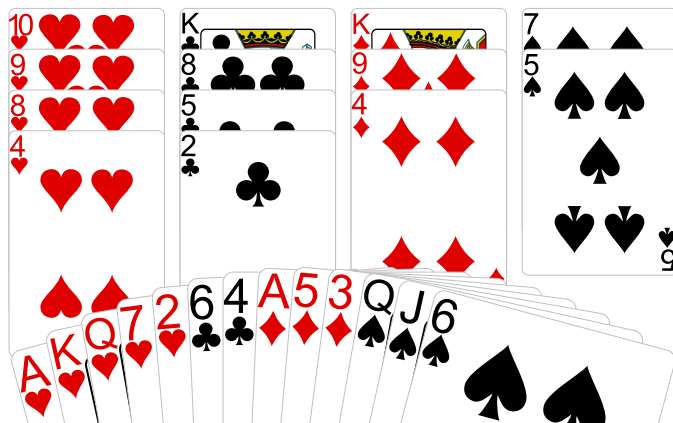
**Count Fast and Slow Losers**

| ♠ | ♥ | ♦ | ♣ | Total |
|---|---|---|---|-------|
|   |   |   |   |       |

**Decide How to Reduce Losers**

| Ruffs | Finesse | Pitch | Length |
|-------|---------|-------|--------|
|       |         |       |        |

**Deal 4** Ctr: 3♥ Goal: at most \_\_\_\_ losers



**Count Fast and Slow Losers**

| ♠ | ♥ | ♦ | ♣ | Total |
|---|---|---|---|-------|
|   |   |   |   |       |

**Decide How to Reduce Losers**

| Ruffs | Finesse | Pitch | Length |
|-------|---------|-------|--------|
|       |         |       |        |

Board: 1  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 4♥  
Declarer: North

Board: 2  
Dealer: **East**  
Contract: 3NT  
Declarer: East

Board: 3  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 2♠  
Declarer: South

Board: 4  
Dealer: **West**  
Contract: 3♥  
Declarer: West

Board: 5  
Dealer: **North**  
Contract: 3NT  
Declarer: North

Board: 6  
Dealer: **East**  
Contract: 4♠  
Declarer: East

**Deal 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A T 9 4  
♥ A 5  
♦ J 9 4 3  
♣ T 7 4

17  
9      8  
6

♠ J 6  
♥ K Q T 8 3 2  
♦ A 7  
♣ A K 3



♠ K Q 3  
♥ J 9 6 4  
♦ 8 6 2  
♣ 9 6 5

♠ 8 7 5 2  
♥ 7  
♦ K Q T 5  
♣ Q J 8 2

West

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by North

North

1♥

4♥

East

Pass

South

2♥

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 1

SOUTH's 2



raise shows 6-10 points and a least three trumps.

NORTH, with 19+ points, decides that game is almost a certainty and bids 4



.

**Deal 2**

East Deals  
N-S Vul

♠ T 9 7  
♥ A 9 6  
♦ K Q 7 3  
♣ K 8 4

8  
12 15  
5

♠ J 6 5 2  
♥ Q J 5 2  
♦ A 2  
♣ T 9 3



♠ K 8 3  
♥ 7 4 3  
♦ 8 6 4  
♣ Q 7 5 2

♠ A Q 4  
♥ K T 8  
♦ J T 9 5  
♣ A J 6

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 2

EAST has an ideal 1NT opening -

15 points and balanced distribution.

With 12 points, WEST knows the partnership total is between 27 and 29, enough for game

but not enough to think about slam. Since WEST has no 4-card Major suit she bids 3NT.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       | 1NT  |       |
| 3NT         |       |      | Pass  |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 3NT by East |       |      |       |

**Deal 3**

North Deals  
None Vul

♠ A 9 5 2  
♥ Q J T  
♦ Q 9 6 3  
♣ Q 9

14  
11 9  
6

♠ Q J 6 4  
♥ A 9 5  
♦ 8 2  
♣ A K 6 3



♠ K T 7 3  
♥ K 6  
♦ T 7 5 4  
♣ 8 5 2

♠ 8  
♥ 8 7 4 3 2  
♦ A K J  
♣ J T 7 4

West

Pass

All Pass

2♠ by South

North

1♣

2♠

East

Pass

South

1♠

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 3

With 6 points, SOUTH must respond to NORTH's 1♣ opening bid.

While it is often correct to respond by bidding suits "up-the-line", SOUTH should

skip over the weak



suit in favor of showing the 4-card

Major ♠ suit.

NORTH knows that SOUTH may only have four ♠s, but with four of her own she can support the

suit. Since she has a minimum opening bid she merely raises to 2♠.

With his minimum response hand SOUTH passes.

**Deal 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 6  
♥ A K Q 7 2  
♦ A 5 3  
♣ 6 4

10  
16 6  
8

♠ A K 8 4 3

♥ J 5 3

♦ J 7 2

♣ J 9



♠ T 9 2

♥ 6

♦ Q T 8 6

♣ A Q T 7 3

♠ 7 5

♥ T 9 8 4

♦ K 9 4

♣ K 8 5 2

**Baker Bidpractice/Set3 4**

With 17 points WEST is not strong enough to insist on game after EAST's raise,

but is strong enough to invite with a 3



bid.

EAST, however, doesn't have anything extra, so declines to go further.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
| 1 ♥         | Pass  | 2 ♥  | Pass  |
| 3 ♥         |       |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 3 ♥ by West |       |      |       |

**Deal 5**

North Deals  
None Vul

♠ J 7  
♥ A 7 5 2  
♦ T 8 3  
♣ T 4 3 2

17  
5      9  
9

♠ A 8 3 2  
♥ K T 9  
♦ A J 7  
♣ K Q 6



♠ T 9 4  
♥ Q J 4  
♦ K Q 5 2  
♣ J 9 5

♠ K Q 6 5  
♥ 8 6 3  
♦ 9 6 4  
♣ A 8 7

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 1NT   | Pass | 2NT   |
| Pass         | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by North |       |      |       |

**Baker Bidpractice/Set3 5**

This is a classic Notrump bidding sequence.

NORTH opens 1NT with 17 points and balanced distribution.

SOUTH, with 9 points is not strong enough to bid game, but invites with 2NT.

NORTH has a maximum, so she accepts the invitation.



**Deal 6**

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K J 8 4  
♥ A K 7 2  
♦ 6 5  
♣ K 9 3

7  
14 14  
5

♠ 7 5 3  
♥ Q T 9 6  
♦ K T 9  
♣ Q T 4



♠ 9 2  
♥ J 8 3  
♦ Q J 3 2  
♣ J 7 6 5

♠ A Q T 6  
♥ 5 4  
♦ A 8 7 4  
♣ A 8 2

**Baker Bidpractice/Set3 6**

With two 4-card Majors WEST should respond  
"up-the-line", bidding



s first.

Then, after EAST bids 1 ♠, WEST has enough  
points to jump all the way to 4 ♠.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       | 1 ♦  | Pass  |
| 1 ♥         | Pass  | 1 ♠  | Pass  |
| 4 ♠         |       |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4 ♠ by East |       |      |       |